Lesson 2.1: WordPress core and custom theme development

What you learn

- **PHP fundamentals.** Variables, arrays, functions and conditionals; WordPress runs on PHP.
- **Template hierarchy.** WordPress picks the template file by page type: single.php for a post, page.php for a page, archive.php for lists, falling back to index.php.
- **Hooks.** Actions run your code at set points (add_action). Filters change a value before it is used (add_filter).
- **wp-config security.** Keep wp-config.php outside public access where possible, use unique salts, disable file editing (DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT) and never commit credentials.

Tools and resources (official sites, not checked live)

- WordPress developer resources
- Theme handbook

ASSIGNMENT

Practice for lesson 2.1

Business problem: Create a child theme with one filter.

Steps

1. Create a child theme folder with style.css and functions.php.
2. Add a filter that appends a line to post titles.
3. Activate it on a test site.

Expected output: The filtered title appears on the site.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Use add_filter('the_title', ...) and return the changed title. A child theme keeps edits safe when the parent updates.

Check yourself

1. Action vs filter?
   Answer: An action runs code; a filter returns a changed value.
2. Why a child theme?
   Answer: Updates to the parent do not erase your changes.

Lesson 2.1 of the **Development and IT** lessons. See this lesson and its official links on skillnavora.in · All chapters and lessons · Open the full lesson guide. Tools, prices and plans change; confirm on each official site.